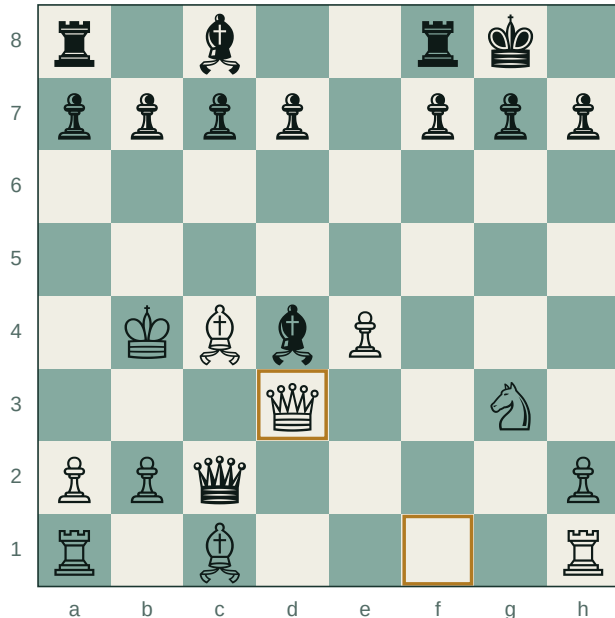


Double checks: Black, move 15

Double checks

Black to move



Previous move: 15.Qd3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

15...a5+ 16. Ka3 Bc5+ 17. b4 axb4#

15...a5+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **16.Ka3**.

16...Bc5+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **17.b4**.

17...axb4# Mate: pawn on b4 and rook on a8 give check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a3. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Pawn on b4 and rook on a8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on b4. Geometrically undefended: rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.